Linguistics 2000: Introduction to Language in the Humanities

Spring 2017
MWF 10:20AM - 11:15AM, 428 Bolz Hall

Instructor Elena Vaikšnoraitė
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Office Hours: TBA

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The entrance to the Linguistics department is located between Gates 22 and 24 on the RPAC side of the stadium.

Course Description and Objectives

This course is an introduction to the scientific study of language. We will discuss the different grammatical components of a language (sounds, words, etc), and how these components can be studied. We will mostly focus on the structure of English, but we will look at some other languages to better understand the variety and systematicity in the human languages.

By the end of this course you should 1) have basic understanding of how language works at different levels, 2) gain analytical skills via examination of linguistic data, 3) be able to think critically about and assess commonly-held beliefs about languages, 4) develop a basic understanding of systematic ways in which languages can be similar or different.

GE information: Cultures and Ideas

This course fulfils the Cultures and Ideas requirement. Students will evaluate significant cultural phenomena and ideas in order to develop capacities for aesthetic and historical response and judgment, and interpretation and evaluation.

Expected Learning Outcomes

- Students analyse and interpret major forms of human thought, culture, and expression.
- Students evaluate how ideas influence the character of human beliefs, the perception of reality, and the norms which guide human behaviour.

This class satisfy these outcomes by teaching students to analyze language as a systematic way of communication as well as guiding students to think critically about commonly-held beliefs about language.

Required textbooks:

Language Files, 12th Edition. Hope Dawson and Michael Phelan (Editors). 2016. The Ohio State University Department of Linguistics. OSU Press.
Language Myths. Laurie Bauer and Peter Trudgill (Editors). 1998. Penguin.

Grade Distribution:

Language Myth Responses	5% (2 x 2.5%)
Linguistics Outside the Classroom	5 % (2 x 2.5%)
Participation	10%
Exams (Including final)	40% (15% midterm and 25% final)
Homework	10 %
Problem sets	30 % (5 x 6%)
Total	100 %

Letter Grade Distribution:

The grading scheme will be the OSU standard.

>= 93	A	73 - 76	C
90 - 92	A-	70 - 72	C-
87 - 89	B+	67 - 69	D+
83 - 86	B	60 - 66	D
80 - 82	B-	<= 59	E
77 - 79	C+		

Course Policies:

- **Attendance and Participation**
  The class is going to be a combination of lecturing and working through language problems together; therefore attendance and participation is crucial. You are expected to come to class prepared, having read the assigned chapter. The grade for participation and attendance depends largely on contributing to class: students are expected to ask clarification questions, participate in problem-solving and in-class discussions, answer questions about the assigned readings, etc.

- **Homework**
  There will be homework exercises assigned on regular basis (about one homework assignment every week). The purpose of the homework exercises is to follow up on what we do in class. Homework assignments will not be graded for correctness, but will be graded as satisfactory or unsatisfactory. As long as I can see that you have made a good-faith effort (i.e. you attempted to answer all the questions), you will receive credit. You should bring solutions to homework assignments to class as we will discuss it in class. If you have to miss a class on which homework is due, you can submit your solutions via Carmen. Correct solutions to homework assignments will not be posted on Carmen, so if you have to miss a class it is your responsibility

- **Problem sets**
  There will be 5 problem sets assigned through the semester; they will all be made available via Carmen. The problem sets will be similar to homework assignments, except that they will be longer (so it's best to start early) and they will be graded for correctness. The assignments are due at the *beginning of class*. Late assignments will be accepted, but they will be marked down by 5% of total points for each late day. The assignments can either be handed in in class, or submitted on Carmen *before class* on the day that it is due. Only PDF files will be accepted if submitting via Carmen; conversion from word to PDF can be done via Microsoft Word.

While working on the problem sets collaboration is NOT allowed. Copying someone else's homework, or allowing someone to copy your homework, is academic misconduct (see more on Academic misconduct under General Policies). I will create discussion boards for each assignment on Carmen, where you can ask me clarification questions, you can also come talk to me during my office hours.

- **Language Myth Responses**
  Throughout the course we will read several essays from *Language Myth* book, and you will write summaries of 2 of the *Language Myth* chapters. In the summary, you are expected to briefly summarise the commonly held myth about language from the *Language Myth* book and the main points covered by the author in the chapter, and then provide a personal reflection on the myth itself and the views expressed by the author. Due dates for each summary are provided in the course schedule below, and a more detailed assignment and a rubric will be provided two weeks before the due date.

- **Exams**
  There will be two in-class exams: the midterm (15%) and a final exam (25%). The midterm will cover phonetics, phonology and morphology. The final exam is non-cumulative; i.e. it will not cover phonetics, phonology, and morphology.

  Exam questions will be very similar to practice exercises in class as well as the problem sets. The questions will only cover the material in Language Files. Exams cannot be made up except with a serious, documented reason (e.g. illness, family emergency).

- **Linguistics Outside the Classroom**
  You are required to attend a talk and/or participate in an experiment twice during the semester. Further information will be given on the LOC handout.

General Policies:

Academic misconduct

The Ohio State University takes academic misconduct very seriously. I am required by University rules to report any suspected academic misconduct to the University Committee on Academic Misconduct (http://oaa.osu.edu/coam.html). As with any class at this university, students are expected to follow the University's Code of Student Conduct. While you are encouraged to discuss assignments with one another, the final write-up must be done individually.

Examples of academic misconduct include but are not limited to:

- copying another student's work
- allowing another student to copy from your work
- copying text from the internet or a book without citing the source (plagiarism)
- paraphrasing someone else's ideas and pretending they are your own
- providing or receiving information during exams

Should you have any questions about this issue or are uncertain as to whether something would be academic misconduct, please consult me.

Students with special needs

The University strives to make all learning experiences as accessible as possible. If you anticipate or experience academic barriers based on your disability (including mental health, chronic or temporary medical conditions), please let me know immediately so that we can privately discuss options. To establish reasonable accommodations, I may request that you register with Student Life Disability Services. After registration, make arrangements with me as soon as possible to discuss your accommodations so that they may be implemented in a timely fashion. SLDS contact information: slds@osu.edu; 614-292-3307; slds.osu.edu; 098 Baker Hall, 113 W. 12th Avenue.

Other resources on campus:

The Student Advocacy Center (advocacy.osu.edu, 614-292-1111) is available to help with any problems you might have navigating OSU, including but not limited to figuring out what to do about academic issues, health issues (including mental health issues and hospitalization), and financial issues.

Title IX states that 'No person in the United States shall, on the basis of sex, be excluded from participation in, be denied the benefits of, or be subjected to discrimination under any education program or activity receiving federal financial assistance.' If you or someone you know has been harassed, assaulted, or discriminated against based on their sex, you can find the appropriate resources to file a formal complaint here:
http://titleix.osu.edu/global.../file-a-complaint/report/
A list of other resources can be found here:
http://titleix.osu.edu/sidebar.../response/resources.html

Finally, mental health issues are common among college students, and are not in anyway indicative of moral or personal failing. If you are exhibiting signs of depression (which can include, but aren't limited to, feelings of helplessness or hopelessness, difficulty concentrating, and trouble eating or sleeping) or other mental health issues, please consider contacting Counselling and Consultation services at (614)292-5766, or ccs.osu.edu.

Course Schedule

Week	Date	Topics	Readings	Other
1	1/9 (M)	Syllabus / Intro		
	1/11 (W)	What do we know when we know a language	LF 1.2-1.4	
	1/13 (F)	What do we know when we know a language 2	LM 10	
2	1/16 (M)	**No class - Martin Luther King Day**		
	1/18 (W)	Phonetics	LF 2.0-2.1	
	1/20 (F)	English consonants	LF 2.2	
3	1/23 (M)	English vowels	LF 2.3	
	1/25 (W)	IPA		
	1/27 (F)	Beyond English sounds	LF 2.4	
4	1/30 (M)	Phonetics / Phonology	LF 3.0-3.1	
	2/1 (W)	Phonology	LF 3.2	
	2/3 (F)	Phonological rules	LF 3.3-3.4	Problem set 1 Phonetics
5	2/6 (M)	Exercises		
	2/8 (W)	Exercises		
	2/10 (F)	Acquisition of phonology	LF 8.2	
6	2/13 (M)	What is morphology	LF 4.0-4.2	
	2/15 (W)	Morphology	LF 4.4	
	2/17 (F)	Word Formation	LF 4.2	
7	2/20 (M)	Hierarchical structure of words	LF 4.4	Problem set 2 Phonology
	2/22 (W)	Morphological types of languages	LF 4.3	
	2/24 (F)	Review		
8	2/27 (M)	**Midterm**		1st LOC due
	3/1 (W)	Syntax	LF 5.0-5.1	
	3/3 (F)	Syntactic Properties	LF 5.2	
9	3/6 (M)	Constituents	LF 5.3	Problem set 3 Morphology
	3/8 (W)	Syntactic Categories	LF 5.4 LM 16	
	3/10 (F)	Constructing a grammar	LF 5.5	1st LM due
	3/13 - 3/17	**No classes - Spring break**		
10	3/20 (M)	Constructing a grammar		
	3/22 (W)	Lexical Semantics	LF 6.0-6.2	
	3/24 (F)	Lexical Semantics		
11	3/27 (M)	Compositional Semantics	LF 6.3-6.4	
	3/29 (W)	Compositional Semantics		
	3/31 (F)	Language Acquisition	LF 8.3	Problem Set 4 Syntax
12	4/3 (M)	Language in Context	LF 7.0-7.2	Problem set 5 Semantics
	4/5 (W)	Rules of Conversation	LF 7.3-7.4	

	4/7 (F)	Presupposition	LF 7.5, LM 1, 8	
13	4/10 (M) 4/12 (W) 4/14 (F)	Language Change Language Change Language Change	LF 13.0-13.2 LF 13.3-13.4 LF 13.5-13.6	
14	4/17 (M) 4/19 (W) 4/21 (F)	Language Variation Language Variation Review	LF 10.0-10.2 LF 10.3-10.4	 2nd LM due
15	4/24 (M)	Review		2nd LOC due
FINAL Th. 4/27 10:00AM-11:45AM				

*Note: I reserve the right to change the syllabus/schedule at any time during the semester, within reasonable limits (e.g. grading policies and exam dates will not change). Changes will be announced in class and an updated syllabus/schedule will be posted on Carmen.